ENG-0024

Postmortem Analysis of Recent Incidents in identity-api

Impact

The identity-api system, designated as SYS-042, experienced two recent incidents (INC-003 and INC-014), both classified as Sev4 severity. Each incident resulted in approximately 59.5 hours of resolution time. Given the high criticality of the system, these disruptions underscore significant operational concerns, potentially affecting downstream processes within Project Sentinel, which is currently on hold.

Timeline

Both incidents were reported by E-167 and involved human error as the root cause. The first incident, INC-003, and the second, INC-014, occurred within a close timeframe, leading to cumulative downtime that impacted system availability. The resolution of each incident took 59.5 hours, reflecting the complexity and the need for targeted corrective actions.

Root Cause

Analysis indicates that both incidents stemmed from human error. The specific circumstances of these errors are under review, but they highlight potential gaps in operational procedures or staff training related to the identity-api system.

Action Items

- Conduct a comprehensive review of operational procedures and staff training programs, with particular focus on human error mitigation strategies.
- Engage Alyssa Day, the project lead for Project Sentinel, to oversee the implementation of improved protocols.
- Review the on-call responsibilities held by Stephen Mckee, the designated on-call employee, to ensure clarity of roles and responsibilities.
- Schedule targeted training sessions for personnel involved with identity-api to reduce the likelihood of future human errors.
- Monitor the system closely for any further anomalies and prepare for a detailed post-incident report to prevent recurrence.

Additional Notes

The identity-api system is owned by Project Sentinel, managed under project ID P-020, which is currently on hold. The system employs a tech stack comprising Go, gRPC, and Redis, and is classified as high criticality. The on-call engineer for this system is Stephen Mckee, a Recruiter based in Brisbane, who has been involved since October 2018.

This postmortem aims to inform ongoing risk mitigation efforts and ensure continuous improvement in system reliability and operational procedures.
